

a clean aesthetic, with a round display and metallic bezel with a matching metallic strap. The display is the same as the G Watch R, as is the processor and RAM. The LTE version of the Urbane supports a nano-SIM allowing you to make calls and send texts directly from the phone.

Smartbands

For those with the money, smartwatches definitely seem like a good buy, especially considering the host of features they provides, not to mention how many of them double up as a classy fashion accessory. However, can we say the same about smart fitness bands?

Smartbands were initially perceived as glorified pedometers. This was however a gross misrepresentation and could not be further from the truth. Considering the massive leaps in sensor technology over the past few years, it is not uncommon for smartbands to feature advanced components such as a heart rate sensor and GPS chip. These bands can also (and in some cases have to) be paired with a smart device such a computer or smartphone to help record and analyze the data collected by the sensors.

Unlink in the case of smartwatches, a display is not priority for smartband manufacturers. In fact, most users prefer that their smartband take accurate sensor readings and have excellent battery life. The other crucial factors include comfort for day-long wear and a non-intrusive design so as to help the devices blend seamlessly with existing apparel. With this in mind, let's take a look at some of the more popular smartbands available for purchase.

Fitbit

The earliest entry in the smartband market, Fitbit has four variants in terms of activity tracker wristbands, namely the Fitbit Flex, Charge, Charge HR, and Surge. They also have two belt-clip or carry-on activity trackers: the Fitbit Zip and Fitbit One. It is important to note that all Fitbit bands feature a display, although the size and type depend on the variant.

In terms of wristbands, the Fitbit Flex is the entry level variant and includes the basic features you would expect in a smartband. The accelerometer acts as a motion detector that can counts the number of steps you take. This helps it calculate your total distance travelled and subsequently, the amount of calories burned. It also features advanced sleep tracking and helps you wake up feeling fresher thanks to its silent vibrating alarm. The display of the Flex is limited to a series of LEDs